

AND OTHER ESSAYS, 1934



LEITH HILL PLACE

From the age of two until he left home to study at the University of Cambridge, Ralph Vaughan Williams lived at this stunning 18th-century house, Leith Hill Place, in Surrey. He gave the house to the National Trust in 1945.

A quiet revolution

The English musical world into which Vaughan Williams was born was dominated by the cultural values of another nation, Germany—via the influences of Wagner and Brahms. But for Vaughan Williams and Gustav Holst, two young, Wagner-admiring composers who met in their student years and became lifelong friends, English music needed a fresh start. Vaughan Williams's work as a church musician soon led to his exploration of a far older heritage—that of Thomas Tallis and William Byrd,